

Moves could endanger gender care for minors

White House threatens hospitals' funding

By Sarah Rahal, Amanda Gokee, and Kay Lazar

GLOBE STAFF

The Trump administration announced Thursday a series of moves aimed at sharply restricting gender-affirming medical care for transgender minors — an escalation that, if enacted, could eliminate access to such care across the United States, even in states like Massachusetts, which has been both a pioneer in gender-affirming care and a haven for people seeking it.

Under the proposals, announced in a news conference led by Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr., the government would bar hospitals that participate in Medicare and Medicaid from performing gender-affirming procedures on patients under 18. A separate rule would block federal Medicaid and Children's Health Insurance Program funding for those treatments for youths 19 and younger.

Because nearly every hospital in the US relies on federal reimbursement, health policy experts say the move could amount to a virtual national ban.

Gender-affirming care — which includes puberty blockers, counseling, hormone treatment, and, in rare cases, surgery — is considered medically necessary by major profession-

TRANSGENDER, Page A10

Trump acts to ease limits on marijuana

Reclassification opens door to more research

By Luke Broadwater and Ashley Southall

NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — President Trump signed an executive order Thursday to downgrade cannabis from the most restrictive category of drugs, easing some limitations and allowing for more research.

The move, which does not decriminalize marijuana, also authorizes a pilot program to reimburse Medicare patients for products made with CBD, a popular compound of cannabis that is not psychoactive.

Trump's order would move marijuana from a Schedule I drug, the same category as heroin, to a Schedule III drug, the same category as ketamine. But it does not legalize the drug, as some states have done, and would not affect law enforcement's approach to making arrests connected to marijuana, according to senior administration officials who spoke on condition of anonymity to describe the order.

"We have people begging for me to do this, people that are in great pain for decades," Trump said as he announced the order from the

MARIJUANA, Page A10

Suspect in Brown shooting, professor's killing found dead

Suicide in N.H. storage unit ends manhunt



MATTHEW J. LEE/GLOBE STAFF

Providence police prepared to search the storage facility in Salem, N.H., on Thursday night.

A well-loved scientist who was pushing for a breakthrough

By Brian MacQuarrie and Laura Crimaldi

GLOBE STAFF

BROOKLINE — Nuno F.G. Loureiro blended in seamlessly on quiet Gibbs Street near Coolidge Corner. Unobtrusive and often smiling, Loureiro was the friendly, middle-age father of three daughters who waved to neighbors as he left his first-floor condo, sometimes headed to a pickup soccer game.



Nuno F.G. Loureiro was fatally shot in Brookline.

Few of those neighbors apparently knew that Loureiro also was an MIT nuclear scientist and physicist, a renowned researcher who had been working toward a revolutionary breakthrough for clean, cheaper, plentiful energy.

On Monday evening, Loureiro was fatally shot at the entrance to his three-story condo building. On Thursday, authorities linked the suspect in Loureiro's murder, 48-year-old Claudio Manuel Neves Valente, to the mass shooting Saturday at Brown University in Providence, which killed two students and wounded nine others.

A native of Portugal, Neves Valente was found dead by suicide at a storage facility in Salem, N.H., Thursday night. Authorities said he had attended the same college program as Loureiro in Portugal and subsequently studied physics in the master's program at Brown for a year in 2000 before withdrawing.

At a news briefing, authorities said they did not have a

LOUREIRO, Page A7

'Tonight, our Providence neighbors can finally breathe a little easier.'

PROVIDENCE MAYOR BRETT SMILEY

Answering the call

At Rhode Island Hospital, the state's only Level 1 trauma center, the staff was ready to deal with mass casualties. **B1.**

Path to recovery

Processing an event like a shooting can be somewhat like grief. **A6.**

This story was reported by Lea Skene, Amanda Milkovits, Dan McGowan, Steph Machado, Sean Cotter, Alexa Gagosz, Steven Porter, and Shelley Murphy, and was written by Skene.

A manhunt that lasted over five days and spanned three states came to a sudden, dramatic end Thursday night when the suspect in the Brown University mass shooting as well as the murder of an MIT professor was found dead from suicide in a storage unit in southern New Hampshire, officials said.

Authorities identified the man as Claudio Manuel Neves Valente, 48, a native of Portugal who briefly attended Brown as a graduate student decades ago. They announced his identity at a news conference late Thursday night. His last known address was in Miami.

Federal prosecutors filed firearm-related charges against Neves Valente, and linked him to both recent shootings. He was also facing state murder charges in Rhode Island.

Neves Valente died of a self-inflicted gunshot wound, officials said.

"Tonight, our Providence neighbors can finally breathe a little easier," Providence Mayor Brett Smiley said. He thanked residents for helping law enforcement solve the case.

Officials said Neves Valente acted alone, as far as they know. But investigators still don't know his motive in either crime, said Ted Docks, special agent in charge of FBI Boston.

Developments throughout Thursday

SHOOTING, Page A6

Brian Walshe was sentenced to life without the possibility of parole for killing his wife, Ana Walshe. Her sister, Aleksandra Dimitrijevic (right) spoke at the sentencing and said, "Her life was unfairly taken." **B1.**



The government accepted liability in the Jan. 29 collision between a military helicopter and a commercial jet. **A2.**

Despite opposition from some families and educators, the Boston School Committee ap-

proved the closures of three schools and reconfigurations of three other buildings. **B1.**

HYM Investment Group broke ground on the second apartment building in its redevelopment of Suffolk Downs. **B5.**

A nice spring to it

Friday: Rainy, windy, warm. High 56-61. Low 28-33.

Saturday: Sun's back, cool. High 38-43. Low 31-36.

Weather and Comics, **G6-7.**

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